“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 5

The Description of the Deeds of Sākṣi-gopāla

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 I bow down to Sākṣi-gopāla, the Lord of the brāhmaṇas, wondrous in His deeds. For a brāhmaṇa’s sake He walked on His own feet, in His form as the Deity, to a land a hundred days’ journey away.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![2]

3 Walking on and on, the Lord came to the village of Yājapura, and there He saw the Deity of Varāha and bowed down to Him.[3]

4 Full of love, He danced and sang and offered many prayers. He stayed that night in Yājapura and then went on His way.[4]

5 He came to Kaṭaka to see Sākṣi-gopāla, and the sight of Gopāla’s beauty filled Him with joy.

6 Absorbed in love, He danced and sang for some time, and in that rapture He offered prayers to Gopāla.

7 He stayed there that night with His devotees, and with delight the Lord heard the old story of Gopāla.[5]

8 Long before, when Nityānanda Gosāñi was travelling to the holy places, He had come to Kaṭaka to see Sākṣi-gopāla.[6]

9 He had heard the story of Sākṣi-gopāla from the people there. Now He told it, and the Lord listened with great happiness.

10 Long ago two brāhmaṇas of Vidyānagara set out together on pilgrimage.[7]

11 They visited Gayā, Vārāṇasī, Prayāga and all the holy places, and then the two of them came joyfully to Mathurā.

12 On their pilgrimage through the forests of Vraja they wandered from forest to forest and saw Govardhana; and when they had visited all twelve forests, they came at last to Vṛndāvana.[8]

13 In Vṛndāvana, at the place of Govinda, there stood a great temple, and in that temple Gopāla was served with great splendour.

14 They bathed at Keśī-tīrtha, Kāliya-hrada and the other holy places, and after seeing Śrī Gopāla they rested there.

15 Gopāla's beauty stole the hearts of both of them, and they stayed there happily for a few days.

16 Of the two brāhmaṇas, one was elderly and the other young, and the younger looked after the elder.

17 The younger brāhmaṇa served him constantly, and the elder was pleased at heart with his service.

18 The elder brāhmaṇa said, “You have served me in so many ways. With your help I have been able to make this pilgrimage.

19 Even a son does not serve his father like this. By your kindness I have felt no fatigue.

20 It would be ingratitude not to honour you. So I shall give you my daughter in marriage.”

21 The younger brāhmaṇa said, “Listen, respected sir! Why do you speak of something impossible, something that can never be?

22 You are of a very noble family and rich in learning, wealth and every other gift, while I am of no family and have neither wealth nor learning.

23 I am not fit to receive your daughter. I serve you for Kṛṣṇa’s pleasure.[9]

24 Kṛṣṇa is greatly pleased by service to brāhmaṇas, and when He is pleased, the wealth of devotion grows.”

25 The elder brāhmaṇa said, “Have no doubt. I shall give you my daughter — what is so surprising in that?”[10]

26 The younger brāhmaṇa said, “You have a wife and sons, many kinsmen and relatives, and a great many friends.

27 Without the consent of them all, a daughter cannot be given in marriage. Bhīṣmaka, the father of Rukmiṇī, is proof of this.

28 Bhīṣmaka wished to give his daughter to Kṛṣṇa, but his son opposed it, and he could not give her.”[11]

29 The elder brāhmaṇa said, “My daughter is my own wealth. Who can forbid me to give away what is my own?

30 I shall give you my daughter, and I shall pay no heed to any of them. Have no doubt; just accept her.”

31 The younger brāhmaṇa said, “If you have truly made up your mind to give me your daughter, then say these true words before Gopāla.”

32 So before Gopāla the elder brāhmaṇa declared, “Know it, Lord: I have given my own daughter to him.”

33 The younger brāhmaṇa said, “Lord, You are my witness. If I see him go back on his word, I will call on You to bear witness.”

34 With these words the two set out for home, and all along the way the younger brāhmaṇa served the elder devotedly, regarding him as his guru.

35 When they reached their own country, each went to his own house. Some days later the elder brāhmaṇa grew anxious at heart:

36 “At a holy place I gave my word to a brāhmaṇa — how can I make it true? My wife, my son, my kinsmen and friends will surely come to know of it.”

37 One day he gathered his family together and told them the whole story.

38 Hearing it, all his relatives cried out in dismay: “Never let such words pass your lips again!

39 If you give your daughter to a lowly man, our family will be ruined, and everyone who hears of it will laugh at us.”

40 The brāhmaṇa said, “How can I break a promise made at a holy place? Come what may, I shall give her in marriage.”

41 His kinsmen said, “Then we shall disown you,” and his wife and son said, “We shall take poison and die.”

42 The brāhmaṇa said, “He will call his witness and have the matter judged. He will win and take my daughter, and my dharma will come to nothing.”[12]

43 His son said, “The witness is only an image, and it is in a distant land. Who will bear witness against you? Why worry?[13]

44 You need not say, ‘I never said it’ — don’t tell that lie. Just say, ‘I remember nothing.’[14]

45 If you say, ‘I know nothing about it,’ I will argue the case and defeat the brāhmaṇa.”[15]

46 Hearing this, the brāhmaṇa grew troubled, and with all his heart he meditated on Gopāla’s feet:

47 “Let my dharma be kept, and let my family not die. O Gopāla, protect them both — I have taken shelter of You.”

48 So the brāhmaṇa pondered within himself. The next day the younger brāhmaṇa came to his house.

49 He came in, bowed down with deep devotion, and with folded hands humbly said:

50 “You promised to give me your daughter. Now you say nothing at all. What kind of conduct is this?”[16]

51 Hearing this, the brāhmaṇa kept silent, and his son came at the young man with a stick in his hand to beat him.

52 “You wretch! You want to marry my sister? You are like a dwarf who wants to catch the moon!”

53 Seeing the stick, the young brāhmaṇa ran away. The next day he gathered the people of the village.

54 The people sent for the elder brāhmaṇa and brought him there, and then the younger brāhmaṇa began to speak:

55 “This man promised to give me his daughter. Now he will not give her — ask him why he behaves like this.”

56 Then everyone asked the brāhmaṇa, “If you gave your word, why do you not give him your daughter?”

57 The brāhmaṇa said, “Listen, good people, to what I have to say: I do not remember ever saying such a thing.”

58 Hearing this, his son found in his father’s words a pretext for a quibble. He came forward and spoke out brazenly:[17]

59 “On the pilgrimage my father carried a great deal of money. When this scoundrel saw it, he wanted to take it.

60 There was no one else with my father — only this man. He fed him *dhuturā* and drove him out of his mind.

61 He took all the money and blamed it on a thief. And now he puts about the story that my father wanted to give him his daughter.

62 All of you, good people, judge for yourselves: is this man fit to receive my father's daughter?"

63 Hearing this, the people began to have doubts: "It may well be so — greed for money makes people lose their fear of dharma."[18]

64 Then the younger brāhmaṇa said, "Listen, honourable people! He is telling lies to win the argument.

65 When this brāhmaṇa was pleased with my service, he himself said, 'I shall give you my daughter.'

66 But I tried to dissuade him: 'Listen, best of the twice-born: I am not a fit husband for your daughter.

67 You are learned, rich and of the noblest family; I am poor, ignorant and lowly, a man of no family. How can we compare?'

68 Still this brāhmaṇa told me again and again, 'I shall give you my daughter; you must accept her.'

69 Then I said, 'Listen, wise sir: your wife, your son and your kinsmen will never consent.

70 You will not be able to give her, and your word will turn out false.' But the brāhmaṇa insisted once more:

71 'I shall give my daughter to you; have no doubt in your heart. It is my own daughter I am giving — who can forbid me?'

72 Then, with my mind made firm, I said, ‘Say these true words before Gopāla.’

73 So he declared before Gopāla, ‘You know it: I have given my daughter to this brāhmaṇa.’

74 Then I made Gopāla my witness, bowed down at His feet and said:

75 ‘If this brāhmaṇa does not give me his daughter, I shall call on You as my witness. Be ready for that.’

76 So in this matter my witness is the Lord Himself, whose word the three worlds accept as truth.”[19]

77–78 Then the elder brāhmaṇa said, “Very well. If Gopāla comes here Himself and bears witness, then I will give my daughter — know this for certain.” His son said, “That is a fair arrangement.”

79 The elder brāhmaṇa thought, “Kṛṣṇa is most merciful. He will surely prove my words true.”

80 The son thought, “An image will never come to bear witness.” Each with his own thought, the two of them agreed.

81 The younger brāhmaṇa said, “Put it down in writing, so that these words cannot be taken back again.”

82 Then all the people together wrote out the document, took the consent of both, and left it in the keeping of an arbiter.

83 Then the younger brāhmaṇa said, “Listen, everyone: this brāhmaṇa is truthful and devoted to dharma.

84 He never wished to go back on his word; he speaks falsely only because he fears his family will die.

85 By the power of his piety I shall bring Kṛṣṇa here and call Him as witness, and so I shall keep this brāhmaṇa's true promise."

86 Hearing this, the atheists laughed, but some said, "God is merciful — He may well come."[20]

87 Then the younger brāhmaṇa went to Vṛndāvana, bowed down flat before Gopāla and told Him everything in detail:

88 "You are the Lord of the brāhmaṇas, and You are most merciful. Be kind and protect the dharma of two brāhmaṇas.

89 I take no joy in the thought that I shall get his daughter. What grieves me deeply is that a brāhmaṇa's promise is being broken.[21]

90 Knowing this, O merciful Lord, bear witness. One who knows the truth and does not bear witness incurs sin."

91 Kṛṣṇa said, "Brāhmaṇa, go back to your home. Call the people together, and then remember Me.

92 I shall appear there and bear witness, and so I shall keep the true promise of both brāhmaṇas."

93 The brāhmaṇa said, "Even if You appear in a four-armed form, no one will believe Your words.

94 But if You go in this very form and bear witness with these very lips, then everyone will listen."

95 Kṛṣṇa said, “Who has ever heard of an image walking?” The brāhmaṇa replied, “Then why do You speak, if You are an image?[22]

96 You are no image — You are the son of the king of Vraja Himself. For a brāhmaṇa’s sake You do even what You would never otherwise do.”[23]

97 Gopāla smiled and said, “Listen, brāhmaṇa: I shall walk behind you.

98 Do not turn round to look at Me. If you see Me, I shall stay on that very spot.

99 You will hear only the sound of My ankle bells, and by that sound you will know that I am following.

100 Cook one *ser* of rice each day and offer it to Me. I shall eat it and walk on with you.”

101 The next day the brāhmaṇa took his leave and set out, and Gopāla walked behind him.

102 As he heard the sound of the ankle bells, his heart was full of joy, and he cooked the finest rice and fed Him.

103 Travelling like this, the brāhmaṇa reached his own country, and as he drew near his village he thought:

104 “Now I have come to the village. I shall go home and tell the people that the witness has come.[24]

105 Unless they see Him with their own eyes, they will not believe. Even if He stays here, there is nothing to fear.”

106 With this thought the brāhmaṇa turned round and looked, and Gopāladeva, smiling, stayed right there.

107 He said to the brāhmaṇa, “Go home now. I shall stay here; I shall go no further.”

108 Then the brāhmaṇa went and told the people in the town, and everyone who heard it was astonished.

109 All the people came to see the witness, and when they saw Gopāla they fell flat in obeisance.

110 The people rejoiced to see Gopāla’s beauty, and they were amazed to hear that the Deity had come walking.

111 Then the elder brāhmaṇa, overjoyed, fell flat before Gopāla in obeisance.

112 Before all the people Gopāla bore witness, and the elder brāhmaṇa gave his daughter in marriage to the younger.

113 Then the Lord said to the two brāhmaṇas, “Birth after birth, you two are My servants.

114 I am pleased with the truthfulness of you both. Ask Me for a boon.” Their hearts full of joy, the two brāhmaṇas asked:

115 “If You will grant us a boon, then stay in this place, so that all the world may know Your mercy to Your servants.”

116 Gopāla stayed, and the two of them served Him. People came from all over the land to see Him.

117 Hearing of this wonder, the king of that land came, and he was supremely pleased to see Gopāla.[25]

118 The king built a temple and established His worship, and the Lord became famous by the name Sākṣi-gopāla.

119 So Sākṣi-gopāla remained in Vidyānagara for a long time, accepting the service of His devotees.[26]

120 The king of Utkala, named Śrī Puruṣottama, made war on that land and conquered it.

121 The victorious king also took that king's throne, called the Māṇikya-siṁhāsana, which was set with many jewels.

122 That Puruṣottama-deva was a great and noble devotee. At Gopāla's feet he prayed, "Come to my kingdom."

123 Won over by his devotion, Gopāla gave His consent, and the king brought Gopāla to Kaṭaka.

124 He brought the Māṇikya-siṁhāsana and presented it to Jagannātha, and in Kaṭaka he established the worship of Gopāla.

125 His queen came to see Gopāla, and with devotion she offered Him many ornaments.[27]

126 In her nose she wore a very costly pearl, and she wished to give it to Him. She thought:

127 "If only there were a hole in the Deity's nose, this maidservant of His could put the pearl in it."

128 With this thought she bowed down and went home. At the end of the night Gopāla spoke to her in a dream:

129 “When I was a child, My mother pierced My nose and with great care put a pearl in it.

130 That hole is still there in My nose. Put in it the pearl you wished to give Me.”

131 The queen told the king what she had seen in her dream, and she came to the temple with the king, bringing the pearl.

132 Seeing the hole, they put the pearl in His nose, and in their joy they held a great festival.

133 From that time Gopāla has resided in Kaṭaka, and this is how the name Sākṣi-gopāla became famous.

134 Hearing the story of Gopāla from Nityānanda’s lips, Mahāprabhu and His devotees were delighted.

135 When the Lord stood before Gopāla, the devotees saw the two of Them as though They were one and the same form.[28]

136 Both were of one colour, and both had large, majestic bodies; both wore red cloth, and both were grave by nature.

137 Both shone with great radiance and had lotus eyes; both were absorbed in ecstasy, and both had faces like the moon.

138 Seeing the two of Them, Nityānanda Prabhu, in great delight, exchanged knowing glances with the devotees and laughed.[29]

139 So they passed that night in great delight, and in the morning, after seeing the *maṅgala-ārati*, the Lord set out.

140 What the Lord saw on the way to Bhuvaneśvara, Vṛndāvana dāsa has described in detail.[30]

141 Coming to Kamalapura, the Lord bathed in the river Bhārgī, leaving His staff in Nityānanda's hands.[31]

142 He went with the devotees to see Kapoteśvara, and meanwhile Nityānanda Prabhu broke the staff.[32]

143 He broke the staff into three pieces and threw them into the river. Then the Lord returned with the devotees from seeing Maheśa.[33]

144 When He saw the temple of Jagannātha, He was overwhelmed. He bowed down flat, and in love He began to dance.[34]

145 The devotees too were overwhelmed, and they all danced and sang; absorbed in love, they went along the royal road with the Lord.

146 The Lord laughed, wept and danced, roaring and thundering. For Him the road of three *krośas* became a thousand *yojanas*.[35]

147 Walking on and on, the Lord came to Āṭhāranālā, and there He regained some outward awareness.[36]

148 The Lord said to Nityānanda, "Give Me My staff." Nityānanda said, "Your staff has broken into three pieces.

149 Overwhelmed by love, You fell, and I caught You. Then I fell sideways with You onto the staff.[37]

150 Under the weight of the two of Us the staff broke into pieces. Where it fell, I do not know.[38]

151 Your staff has been broken through My offence. Punish Me as You see fit."

152 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu showed a little sorrow, and with slight anger He said:[39]

153 "You have all done Me a fine service on the way to Nīlācala! My only wealth was My staff, and you did not even keep that safe.

154 Either all of you go ahead to see the Lord, or I go ahead; I will not go together with you."[40]

155 Mukunda Datta said, "Lord, You go ahead. We shall all follow behind; we shall not go with You."

156 Hearing this, the Lord went on ahead with swift steps. No one can understand the minds of the two Lords.

157 Why does one of Them break the staff, and why does the Other let Him? And having let Him break it, why does the Other then blame Him in anger?

158 This pastime of the breaking of the staff is profound indeed. Only one whose devotion to the feet of both is steadfast can understand it.[41]

159 Blessed is this glory of Gopāla, the Lord of the brāhmaṇas: Nityānanda was its narrator, and Śrī Caitanya its listener.[42]

160 Whoever hears this with faith will very soon attain the feet of Gopāla.[43]

161 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. Heading in the edition: “Obeisance to Sākṣi-gopāla, who is subdued by His devotee”. *Anubhāṣya*: the land a hundred days’ journey away — from the region of Mathurā to Vidyānagara; *adbhutehaṁ* is one word, “whose deeds are unprecedented”. ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 4.2; translation as there. ↩
3. Heading in the edition: “At Yājapura the Lord has darśana of Varāha-deva”. *Anubhāṣya*: Yājapura, a subdivision of the Kaṭaka district, is called “Nābhi-gayā”; Varāha-deva resides there in the quarter called Brāhmaṇanagara. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: a holy place of Utkala on the bank of the Vaitaraṇī, in Virajā-kṣetra. ↩
4. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads যাজপুরে সে রাত্রি রহি’ করিলা গমন (“staying that night in Yājapura, He went on”); another reading is …করিলা যাপন (“He spent that night in Yājapura”). ↩
5. Heading in the edition: “Spending that night in the temple, the Lord hears the story of Sākṣi-gopāla from Nityānanda’s lips”. ↩
6. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: at that time Sākṣi-gopāla resided in Kaṭaka, the chief town on the Mahānadī. Brought from the south, He stayed a few days in Kaṭaka and then for some time in the temple of Jagannātha at Purī; when a “loving quarrel” (*prema-kalaha*) arose there, the king of Utkala founded the village of Satyavādī, three *krośas* from Purī, and placed Gopāla there. He now resides in that village, in a stone temple. ↩
7. Heading in the edition: “The story of Sākṣi-gopāla; the account of the two brāhmaṇas”. ↩
8. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: of the twelve forests, Bhadra, Bilva, Lauha, Bhāṇḍīra and Mahāvana lie east of the Yamunā, and Madhu, Tāla, Kumuda, Bahulā, Kāmya, Khadira and Vṛndāvana to the west. Having seen them, the brāhmaṇas came to the village of Pañcakrośī Vṛndāvana, which lies within Vṛndāvana, one of the twelve forests, stretching sixteen *krośas* to Nandagrāma and Varṣāṇā. ↩
9. *Anubhāṣya* (on 23–24): the younger brāhmaṇa served the elder, a devotee of the Lord, for Kṛṣṇa’s pleasure, and the fruit of that service was that Śrī Gopāla bore witness to protect His devotee’s honour. Had this service and the consent to the

marriage been mundane *karma-kāṇḍa* for sense gratification, Śrī Caitanya and Śrī Nityānanda would never have honoured them. ↩

10. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads ইথে কি বিস্ময় (“what is surprising in that?”); another reading is করিল নিশ্চয় (“I have firmly decided”). ↩
11. *Anubhāṣya*: Bhīṣmaka, king of Vidarbha, had five sons and one daughter; his kinsmen wished to give her to Kṛṣṇa, but his eldest son, Rukmī, who hated Kṛṣṇa, prevented it (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.52.21–25). When Kṛṣṇa carried Rukmiṇī away, Rukmī fought Him; at Rukmiṇī’s plea Kṛṣṇa spared his life, but shaved him and so disgraced him. ↩
12. *Anubhāṣya*: the elder brāhmaṇa thought, “If I do not give my daughter as I promised, the younger brāhmaṇa will call Śrī Gopāla as witness and take my daughter by force, and then my dharma will bear no fruit.” ↩
13. *Anubhāṣya* (on 43–45): the elder brāhmaṇa’s son was an unbeliever (*nāstika*) and a *smārta*, clever in worldly affairs but foolish; he did not believe that the Śrī Vigraha is conscious and all-pervading, and like an idolater he saw in Him stone and wood — hence he calls the witness “an image” (*pratimā*). ↩
14. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: do not tell such a lie as “I never promised my daughter”; say only, “I do not remember it.” ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya*: the son advises his father, as Yudhiṣṭhira said “Aśvatthāmā is slain — the elephant”, not to disown the promise with an open lie but only to say, or to make it appear, that he remembers nothing; then the son will catch the younger brāhmaṇa in a snare of false arguments (*kutarka*), defeat him and save the family’s honour. *Nyāya* — argument (*tarka*). ↩
16. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads কি তোমার ব্যবহার (“what conduct is this of yours?”); another reading is কি তোমার বিচার (“what is your decision?”). ↩
17. *Anubhāṣya*: *chala* (a quibble) is when a speaker uses a word in one sense and his opponent, refusing that sense, invents the opposite and builds false charges on it. ↩
18. *Anubhāṣya*: greed for wealth destroys people’s discrimination between dharma and adharma; therefore the people suspected that the younger brāhmaṇa, out of greed, might have done the elder some violence. ↩
19. *Anubhāṣya*: *mahājana* here means the Deity (*devatā*). ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya*: they are atheists (*nāstika*) because they do not believe that Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Lord who loves His devotees, and see in His arcā-vigraha only earthly matter. ↩
21. *Anubhāṣya*: the brāhmaṇa asks for testimony not so that he may marry and gratify his senses, but only to free Gopāla’s devotee, the elder brāhmaṇa, from the sin of a broken promise and to uphold his word. ↩

22. *Anubhāṣya* (on 95–96): the Lord asked this to test the brāhmaṇa and to clear him of any suspicion of being an idolater (*pauttalika*), one who sees in Viṣṇu's arcā-vigraha stone and wood; and the brāhmaṇa answered as a true devotee who believes that Viṣṇu is God, the Lord of all lords. ↩
23. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: for a brāhmaṇa's good You do all that it would not befit You to do. ↩
24. The Bengali text follows the edition (p. 377, checked under magnification): সাক্ষির আগমন (previously আগমনে), rhyming with ভবন. ↩
25. Heading in the edition: "The story of Śrī Gopāla and Puruṣottama, king of Utkala". ↩
26. *Anubhāṣya*: Vidyānagara was a provincial capital of the Orissan kingdom in the region called Koṭadeśa, where the Godāvarī meets the Bay of Bengal; the town stood on the south bank of the Godāvarī, twenty to twenty-five miles south-east of Rājamahendrī. The former king of Utkala, Puruṣottama, brought it under his rule; in Pratāparudra's time Rāmānanda Rāya governed it. Vijayanagara (Vizianagaram) is not this Vidyānagara. ↩
27. Heading in the edition: "The story of Śrī Gopāla and the queen". ↩
28. Heading in the edition: "Seeing the Lord beside Gopāla, the devotees see Them as one". ↩
29. Heading in the edition: "Seeing this, Nitāi laughs merrily with the devotees". ↩
30. Heading in the edition: "The darśana of Bhuvaneśvara and the rest are described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*". *Anubhāṣya*: *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya 2 — the Lord came to Bhuvaneśvara, Gupta-kāśī, where Śiva dwells, and bathed in the lake Bindu-sarovara, which Śiva created by bringing the water of all the holy places drop by drop. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: from Bālakāṭi on the royal road out of Kaṭaka to Bhuvaneśvara is two or three *krośas*. ↩
31. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the river Bhārgī is now known as the Daṇḍabhāṅgā ("the Broken Staff"); it lies three *krośas* north of Purī. ↩
32. Heading in the edition: "The Lord goes to see Kapoteśvara, and Nitāi secretly breaks His staff". *Anubhāṣya*: Kapoteśvara is a Śiva-liṅga. ↩
33. *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Gaurasundara had accepted *eka-daṇḍa sannyāsa* at Kāṭoyā in the Bhāratī line, which descends from Śaṅkara. At the stages of *kuṭīcaka* and *bahūdaka* the staff is to be kept; at the stages of *haṁsa* and *paramahaṁsa* it is given up. Gaurahari is the Lord of the fourteen worlds and has no need, like other sannyāsīs, to display a lower stage; knowing this, Nityānanda broke the staff and threw it into the Bhārgī. ↩
34. Heading in the edition: "Seeing the temple at Purī, the Lord, pained by separation from Kṛṣṇa, dances, overwhelmed". *Anubhāṣya*: the temple (*deula*)

is the present temple of Śrī Jagannātha, built by King Anaṅgabhīma. ↩

35. *Anubhāṣya*: in intense separation a moment seems an age; so the road of three *krośas* seemed to Mahāprabhu a thousand *yojanas*. ↩
36. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Āṭhāranālā is the bridge of eighteen arches at the entrance to the town of Purī. ↩
37. Heading in the edition: “Nitāi’s cleverness: He reports that the staff is broken”. ↩
38. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads সেই দণ্ড কাঁহা পড়িল (“where that staff fell”); another reading is সেই খণ্ড (“those pieces”). ↩
39. *Anubhāṣya*: Nityānanda knew that Mahāprabhu had no need of the staff of a sannyāsa taken by rule (*vaidha-sannyāsa*), and relieved Him of it. The Lord showed anger for the people’s sake: if the staff were given up in this way, the Vedic rules would slacken, and some, following the conduct of the great, would mistake a lawless life for the path of *anurāga* and neglect the path of rules favourable to bhakti. ↩
40. Heading in the edition: “The Lord expresses His wish to go alone to see Jagannātha”. ↩
41. *Anubhāṣya*: only those who have truly, firmly and calmly understood Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda will grasp this pastime. Mahāprabhu accepts that a *sādhaka* following the path of the great souls needs sannyāsa by rule, and takes the staff to teach the world; Nityānanda knew that at the highest, *paramahaṁsa* stage the staff is not needed, and so that people would not mistake Mahāprabhu for a sannyāsī of a lower stage, He made Him give it up, showing the example of the very highest stage. ↩
42. Heading in the edition: “Narrator and listener are both Bhagavān; therefore the story of Sākṣi-gopāla is not of this world”. *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Gopāla’s form is the eternally true vigraha; He is Truth itself and, overriding worldly laws, always upholds the honour of truth; truthfulness is especially needed in a brāhmaṇa’s life; Kṛṣṇa Himself both establishes brahminhood and is subdued by it, so brahminhood that has taken shelter of Kṛṣṇa is not mundane. ↩
43. Heading in the edition: “The faithful listener attains the feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa”. ↩